

Adult guide - E04 Look Again: How We Check

Version: review 1.0.1

Story: The Garden Welcome Sign

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What this book is for

E04 is a read-aloud story and activity book for Early Years / Foundation. It continues directly from E03 at the garden gate. The child helps Mia, Sol, Tavi and one new guest, Ivo, rebuild and check a four-picture welcome sign before the morning visitors arrive.

With an adult, the child should increasingly be able to:

- point to what the picture plan actually shows before answering;
- copy four pictures, cover them and make the complete sign again;
- keep a try that does not match so it can be compared with the plan;
- follow four step cards from first to last and find the first changed move;
- use one ribbon for side-to-side width and another for bottom-to-top height;
- let a friend make their own check without seeing or copying the first answer; and
- notice whether a check shows a match, a difference or another question to answer.

This is not a general classroom checking lesson with SFT language added. Its sequence comes from the maintained E04 syllabus and the receipt-backed SFT boundaries below.

Opening recap and invitation

Book Four and Level Four must make sense to a child who has just finished Level Three, has read only the books, or selects Level Four later. The opening should:

1. welcome the child back to Mia, Sol and Tavi;
2. recall that they repaired the turning-light trail by keeping Sol's first try;
3. show the trio at the exact garden gate teased at the end of E03;
4. reveal one clear new problem: the four-picture welcome sign must be rebuilt and checked before the morning visitors arrive;
5. introduce Ivo as the sole new guest, with his moss-green body, round lens and checkerboard satchel visible before his job is described;
6. show the picture plan, blank sign and closed gate so the mission has a visible cause; and
7. preview looking, building, remembering, tracing, measuring and friend checking without revealing any challenge answer.

The story contains no unexplained package, ramp, magical instruction note or new location jump. Every move follows from the same sign-and-gate mission.

Experience before vocabulary

Do not use a learning word as though the child already knows it. Let the child see or perform the action first, then give the short name and meaning.

- Show the picture plan before using the adult/reviewer word source.
- Let the child look and answer before naming an observation.
- Ask whether two pictures are the same or different before introducing compare, confirm or disagree.
- Keep and follow Sol's four step cards. Use step cards with the child; keep the formal word trace in the reviewer-only boundary.
- Move from side to side before naming that distance width.
- Move from bottom to top before naming that distance height.
- Let Ivo build without seeing the team's sign before naming his work an independent check.
- Say that a check can show a match, a difference or another question before using the adult summary confirm, disagree or more work.

Use picture plan, Sol's first try, step cards, one question at a time and Ivo's own check without copying in speech to the child. Keep source, failed attempt, declared question, supported record and fresh path for adult or reviewer explanation.

Scientific authority and exact boundary - reviewer only

This section protects the exact SFT boundary. It is not a read-aloud script and the child is not expected to repeat its terminology.

SFT - FOUNDATION - DERIVATION - TRACE - 001

- Claim title: Complete replayable derivation trace
- Receipt:
sha256:457414dd7e3a14e44b200b1ac329cdc9e2bb3527abe901c3255d7fb6f9233c5e
- Status: model admitted, depth-independent, independently replicated
- Exact role in E04: an admitted finite derivation has one complete ordered source- and dependency-bound record that deterministically replays every registered operation, intermediate and terminal result.

The four picture-placement cards translate the experience of keeping steps in order. They are not derivation identities, and replaying a classroom sign does not prove the formal claim.

SFT - FOUNDATION - MEASURED - VALUE - BOUNDARY - 001

- Claim title: One-way derivation-to-measurement boundary

- Receipt:
sha256:a4e409f6bb8b203de746bd0c21d3f2566e8052003219490c657249e11f6f2086
- Status: model admitted, depth-independent, independently replicated
- Exact role in E04: the exact source-bound law and target question are fixed before measurement is opened; measurement preserves every row and cannot select or mutate the law.

The WIDTH and HEIGHT ribbons translate the one-question boundary. A width result answers width only. It cannot establish picture order, height, beauty, truth or SFT authority. A measuring tool answers only the question we chose and declared.

SFT-FOUNDATION-ADMISSION-ENFORCEMENT-001

- Claim title: Single fail-closed SFT admission law
- Receipt:
sha256:0e21ffcb217271ddfab4000901691761c2b7fd423b93d27f81ab757f0300c58c
- Status: model admitted, depth-independent, independently replicated
- Exact role in E04: the complete fail-closed authority path preserves adverse, rejected and unresolved dispositions; an incomplete route does not gain authority.

Sol's first rebuild, its changed step and the width-only conclusion remain in the checking book. The closed gate is an educational image of a halt: it opens only after every declared classroom checkpoint has a visible record. The gate is not the formal admission engine.

SFT-ENG-INDEPENDENT-CHECK-001

- Claim title: Implementation-distinct check
- Receipt:
sha256:927d1b0f871cb92e06ae180a9c1fbcf6b2fe0a024135fb487fbf41a9b082b364
- Status: model admitted, empirically tested and independently reconstructed
- Branch: Engineering Translation
- Exact bounded role in E04: an independent check reconstructs through a separately identified implementation path while preserving specifications, results, disagreements and provenance.

Ivo uses the original source, fresh pieces and a separate work area without seeing the team's answer. This is a child-scale translation of a fresh path. It does not claim that two children constitute formal independent certification.

What the activities do not prove

A picture plan, memory game, measuring ribbon, garden gate or friend's answer is a bounded educational demonstration. None derives, validates or changes an SFT law. The book does not assert that agreement makes a statement true, that disagreement makes it false, or that a physical fit confers scientific status.

The following remain excluded:

- measurement or observed success selecting a derivation;
- one tool answering a property it was not chosen to measure;

- self-checking relabelled as independent checking;
- deletion of wrong, missing, unresolved or inconvenient attempts;
- guessing, voting, adult confidence or praise as evidence;
- binary digits or signed proof labels;
- semantic numerical zero;
- floating-point equality;
- completed infinity or an ungenerated continuum; and
- outside models, standards or curricula as authority in SFT derivation.

Story cause-chain

Keep the mission audible: rebuild and check the Garden Welcome Sign before the morning visitors arrive.

- Pages 3-5: E03's repaired trail reaches the closed garden gate; the sign problem appears; Ivo joins as the sole new guest.
- Pages 6-8: the child looks at one requested picture in the visible plan, then meets the words observation and guess after answering.
- Pages 9-11: the child builds all four pictures while the picture plan is visible.
- Pages 12-14: the plan is covered; Sol rebuilds from memory while Ivo keeps one card for each move; the plan is uncovered; Sol's try stays visible.
- Pages 15-16: the child compares every marked corner and identifies the two changed pictures.
- Pages 17-19: the child follows Sol's four placement cards and finds Step 3 as the first move that differs from the picture plan.
- Pages 20-22: the repaired sign's width is measured; the result is explicitly prevented from answering picture or height questions.
- Pages 23-25: Ivo builds from the same picture plan without seeing the team's sign; after the two signs are compared, the word confirm is introduced.
- Pages 26-27: Mia treats the width answer as a whole-sign answer; Ivo points out that bottom-to-top distance has not been checked; measuring introduces the word height and answers that missing question.
- Pages 28-30: each of four questions is matched to the illustrated check card that answers it before the gate opens.
- Pages 31-32: the narrator addresses the child directly; the checked sign guides visitors; a closed Star Door quietly teases later learning without inventing an unsupported title.

If the child loses the story, point to the picture plan, rebuilt sign and closed gate. Restate the mission rather than skipping to an answer.

Challenge and reveal answers

- Page 7 - Which picture is with MOON? The picture plan shows BEE. Ask the child to point to the actual picture before naming it.

- Page 10 - Build from the picture plan. Sunflower goes to SUN, bee to MOON, watering can to LEAF and boot to STAR. Use every card once.
- Page 13 - Does Sol's memory rebuild match? Offer MATCH, DOES NOT MATCH and NOT SURE. A child who correctly remembers the difference must not be forced to choose NOT SURE. Do not mark any of the three answers before page 14 reveals that bee and boot traded places.
- Page 15 - Which pictures differ? BEE and BOOT. Compare all four corners; do not infer that every picture changed.
- Page 18 - Where did the swap begin? STEP 3 first differs from the plan by placing BOOT at MOON. Step 4 is also different, but it is later.
- Page 21 - Does the width fit? FITS. Both sign edges align with the green WIDTH marks.
- Page 24 - Are the two signs the same or different? SAME. Page 25 then introduces confirm: Ivo's independently rebuilt picture positions match the repaired team sign.
- Page 26 - What has not been checked? MEASURE BOTTOM TO TOP. Guessing or voting cannot measure the missing distance. Page 27 introduces the word height after the child sees that measurement.
- Page 29 - Can every question be given a check card? Yes: the picture-plan comparison answers the picture question, the horizontal ribbon answers width, the vertical ribbon answers height and Ivo's own sign answers the independent-check question.

Wrong answers are useful to keep. Leave the child's selected card or route in place long enough to ask, "What are we checking?" and "Which card or picture shows us?" Avoid "No, that is wrong," "You are clever," or revealing the correct object with a pointing gesture before the attempt.

What the narrator explains after each game

Each explanation comes after a completed attempt. It names the action, result, idea and story purpose without giving away the next stage.

1. Look-and-Point: You looked at the plan and found the bee beside the moon. You answered from what you could see. That is an observation.
2. Build-the-Board: You put every picture beside the same symbol as the plan. Now the sign can be checked against that plan.
3. Curtain Memory: You looked, covered the plan and rebuilt. When the curtain opened, Sol's try stayed there. A try that does not match can still help.
4. Difference Finder: You checked all four places. Bee and boot were different; the other two matched. Looking at both signs helped you find the change.
5. Step Cards: You followed Sol's cards from Step 1 and found the first mix-up at Step 3. Keeping steps in order helps us find where a change began.
6. Measuring Ribbon: You checked side to side and found that the width fits. The ribbon told us about width only. It did not check the pictures or height.
7. Ivo's Own Check: Ivo used the same plan but did not look at the team sign. His own sign matched. A check made without copying can confirm a result.
8. Missing-Height Check: You noticed that width did not answer bottom to top. You measured height instead of guessing or voting. Sometimes we need one more check.

9. Four-Question Check: You matched each question to the card that showed its answer. When all four questions had checked answers, the gate could open.

Canonical final fourth-wall explanation

The eventual game's spoken captions should use these short visual beats rather than one long, formal paragraph:

- > You checked what was really shown.
- > You kept Sol's first try and followed his steps to find the first change.
- > One ribbon checked width. Another checked height. Ivo made his own check without copying.
- > Sometimes a check shows a match. Sometimes it shows a difference. Sometimes it tells us what to check next. That is why checking helps.

Plain-language meanings

- Picture plan: the kept picture the child can look at while building and checking.
- Observation: saying what we can see in the shown plan or scene.
- Guess: choosing an answer without checking what is shown.
- Source: the adult/reviewer word for the kept starting plan.
- Rebuild: make the complete arrangement again from the picture plan or memory.
- Try that did not match: a useful try to keep and compare.
- Trace: the adult/reviewer term for the complete ordered step record. Say step cards to the child.
- Compare: look at two things side by side for what is the same and what is different.
- Width: distance from one side to the other side.
- Height: distance from the bottom to the top.
- Independent check: a friend uses the same picture plan without seeing or copying the first answer.
- Confirm: the new check gives the same result for the question being checked.
- Different / disagree: two results or ideas do not match.
- Another check: one of the questions still needs an answer.

Do not use deterministic replay, target opening, disposition receipt, implementation carrier, provenance class or fail-closed admission as unexplained child shorthand.

Running the book activity

Use four large picture cards, a sheet divided into four marked spaces and a cloth. Draw the picture plan before the activity. The child's pictures may be simple but each must have a

word or shape cue so colour is never the only identifier.

1. Read pages 3-8 and point to what the picture plan actually shows.
2. Build the sign with the picture plan visible.
3. Photograph or sketch the first build if it cannot safely remain in place.
4. Cover the picture plan and rebuild on a second sheet. Make or photograph one simple step card after each placement so the later step-card activity has been visibly prepared.
5. Uncover and compare every marked space. Keep the second build even if it differs.
6. Hang the four step cards in the order the pictures were placed. Follow them from first to last.
7. Ask a width question and a height question separately with separate strips of paper.
8. If possible, let a second person rebuild from the picture plan without seeing the first answer. If that is not possible, describe the idea; do not call a second look by the same person independent.

The child may point, speak, use eye gaze or choose between large cards. Physical rebuilding is optional.

Safe physical activity

Use large cards that cannot be swallowed, a light paper or cardboard board and a soft cloth. Do not hang a heavy sign, use a working gate, give a child a glass lens, or ask them to stretch a rigid or retracting metal tape. The game's lens is fictional; a real activity should use a cardboard viewing ring. Adult hands operate scissors, fasteners and elevated displays.

Accessibility

- Every picture has a name above it and a distinct shape; colour is secondary.
- The four spaces use sun, moon, leaf and star markers instead of position or colour alone.
- WIDTH and HEIGHT tools carry both words and directional edge cues.
- Picture plan, Sol's first try, repaired sign and Ivo's check use persistent labels.
- Challenge choices remain visible until the separate reveal.
- All descriptions name the relevant plan, try, step, tool and result.
- The accessible HTML preserves page order and exposes each picture description beside the page text.
- Every game drag or movement has a labelled tap and keyboard alternative.
- Reduced-motion mode removes decorative movement without removing state.
- Local narration must match captions exactly. Sound and colour are never required to understand an answer.

Companion Level Four contract

Level Four retains Mia, Sol and Tavi as the permanent trio and introduces only Ivo. It opens with a magical recap and invitation, then presents nine connected stages. Each stage has a

genuinely different replayable mechanic:

1. sweep a magnifying lens over a picture plan and tag the requested observed picture while decoys move between rounds;
2. place four picture pieces into four symbol-marked sign spaces, with shuffled layouts that are always solvable and a clear reset;
3. study a varied board, close the curtain, rebuild it and uncover the same picture plan, retaining the exact attempt;
4. compare two full boards and mark all changed positions before the mistake allowance runs out;
5. inspect four ordered placement cards and stop at the first step that differs from the picture plan;
6. align a tactile width ribbon between two hooks, with too-short, fit and too-wide rounds that answer width only;
7. direct Ivo through a separate build route, then connect matching results without exposing the team's answer during his build;
8. identify that bottom-to-top distance is still unchecked, then operate a height tool while guess and vote choices visibly fail to measure it; and
9. route source, width, height and friend-check evidence cards to four gate checkpoints; unsupported or mismatched evidence halts the gate and can be retried.

Every stage includes meaningful success, recoverable mistakes, feedback, retry, replay and bounded variation. No stage is a nested sequence of “Next” buttons. Characters move within each scene, and the active tool or record is large enough for phone touch.

Level Four has its own gentle garden-checking score, distinct from Levels One through Three. It may use soft wooden taps, leaf rustles and short lens chimes, but music must never signal an answer. Music, narration and effects have separate remembered controls. App switching pauses all audio; returning resumes the current visual state without replaying an old or completed line.

The level stores stage, round, source board, exact failed attempt, trace, measurement questions and completed checks. Returning to the menu and resuming must restore those exact records. Completion provides replay, level select and the sequential next-learning option when such a reviewed level exists.

Connecting the book and Level Four

The book and game teach the same caused story in distinct ways. The book gives time for challenge-and-reveal comparison. The game lets the child operate each tool, make a recoverable mistake and replay with a new bounded arrangement.

- Begin with: “We are rebuilding and checking one welcome sign before the visitors arrive.”
- Ask “What can you see?” before “What do you think?”
- Keep the picture plan and first try in view after a reveal.
- When stuck, restate the question and point to the available cards or pictures; do not point to the correct choice.

- After a game explanation, invite the child to find the same action in the book. Neither medium is homework for the other.

Optional picture codes

Codes never reveal an answer, skip an attempt or grant learning progress.

- LOOKCLOSE - page 8: Ivo's lens reflects the four corner symbols.
- SIGNMAKER - page 11: the completed frame grows a harmless flower vine.
- KEEPFIRST - page 14: Sol adds a “useful try” ribbon to the saved board.
- SPOTCHANGE - page 16: bee and boot perform a cosmetic place-swap replay.
- FOLLOWSTEPS - page 19: the four trace cards make four soft leaf sounds.
- WIDTHONLY - page 22: the width ribbon rolls itself into Ivo's satchel.
- FRIENDCHECK - page 25: matching picture pairs exchange a glow.
- MOREWORK - page 27: Mia and Ivo share a friendly checking wave.
- ALLCHECKED - page 30: the open gate plays a short garden greeting.

External references

The UK Early Years Foundation Stage framework may calibrate language length, safe activity, communication and accessibility. Publisher conventions and other educational games may inform usability comparisons. None is authority for SFT claims, topic order or derivation.

Review and publication status

Review version 1.0.1 remains under edu/. It may be rendered and tested as a live review work. It must not be copied into publications/education, described as finally approved or released as a child-facing hosted service until Maria Smith explicitly approves this exact book and companion level.